
A Manager's Guide

8 PRACTICAL
WAYS TO
MOTIVATE
AND ENGAGE
YOUR TEAM
FOR
HIGH PERFORMANCE



*Tools and techniques to
take action today and make a
difference in your workplace*

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**A Manager's Guide:
8 Practical Ways To Motivate and
Engage Your Team
For High Performance**

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Introduction

It's a sobering fact that over 87% of the global workforce is not actively engaged with the organizations they work in. That's a lot of untapped potential, unmotivated workers and unhappiness in the workplace!

Here's an even more sobering fact: poor employee motivation and engagement boils down to managers.

Yes, *you*, as a manager, have a massive impact on how motivated, satisfied and engaged your team members are. So how would you rate your leadership skills when it comes to keeping your employees engaged and performing well?

The low levels of employee engagement worldwide mean that as leaders and managers, we have much room to improve when it comes to motivating our teams to perform at their best. And the first step to doing so is to educate yourself on *how* to better motivate and engage your employees.

What does employee motivation and engagement mean to you, and how can you (and your organization) be better at it? For many organizations, employee engagement is something that they only pay lip service to – it is something to be ticked off as a corporate strategy, but there is no real commitment to it. For others, they may not see tangible value in having an employee engagement strategy, because they're more focused on revenue and business results.

But here's the thing: *engagement does matter!* Motivated and engaged employees are fantastic assets for any company. Research has shown that high levels of employee engagement leads to tangible business results such as improved sales, productivity and profits.

In this eBook, we examine what employee engagement means, the barriers faced by organizations and managers, and why management and leadership have a significant role to play in building employee engagement.

We also share eight practical tactics that you can implement today in order to get your team more motivated, more engaged, and performing at a higher level. As a manager, you can have a direct impact on your team's morale and performance, and our tips are designed to equip you to take action immediately and make a difference.

The ideas in this eBook are meant to be applied – employee motivation and engagement are not just theories! It's important to translate these concepts into actionable behaviour which is why each of our eight practical tactics include exercises to get you thinking and, more importantly, *doing*.

We hope you find this eBook informative, practical and useful!

For more information on our online management training programs, visit <http://www.LeadToSucceedNow.com>

The Basics: Employee Engagement and Motivation

Before we dive into the eight practical tactics, let's start with the basics and clarify the terminology that we'll be using in this eBook. Employee engagement has become a buzzword nowadays, so what is it exactly?

In this section, we explain the differences and links between employee satisfaction, motivation and engagement. Our aim is to help you understand how employee satisfaction and motivation relate to the bigger picture of employee engagement.

What is Employee Engagement?

Employee engagement describes the process of encouraging a positive attitude amongst employees in order to maximize their performance.

What is the difference between employee engagement, satisfaction and motivation?

Employee Satisfaction

Employee satisfaction deals with happiness. Are employees happy at work? Are they getting what they want, desired salary, benefits, etc.?

Consider the employee who comes to work each morning and leaves immediately at the end of working hours - the one who asks the question, "What's in it for me?"

Satisfied – yes.

Motivated – *maybe*.

Engaged - *no*.

Employee Motivation

Employee motivation is about getting something in return for their efforts.

Employees are motivated by the prospect of getting a bonus, benefit or recognition. They may even be motivated to take on more responsibilities and get promoted. They are motivated by personal gain and may not always do what is best for the company.

Satisfied – yes.

Motivated – yes.

Engaged – *no*.

Employee Engagement

Employee engagement is a completely different attitude; it's the Holy Grail.

An employee who is engaged is proud of the organization he or she works for and **will go above and beyond** what is required of them in order to see their organization succeed.

Both the motivated employee and the satisfied employee can be excellent performers. They are performing at a level that is expected of them by the company. *But they aren't engaged.*

An engaged employee is going to work toward moving the business to the next level. An engaged employee will ask, **"What is in it for us?"** An engaged employee will be committed to doing his or her best in order to achieve organizational goals.

Satisfied – yes.

Motivated – yes.

Engaged – yes.

As a manager, you may already be familiar with employee satisfaction and motivation as ideas, but the next step is to grow employee engagement!

To grow employee engagement, you should implement initiatives that create an environment where employees...

- see and understand the overall aim of the business
- feel valued by you, their manager
- are comfortable expressing their own views.

Nurturing this environment is an important task for all layers of leadership and management as well as HR departments. Regardless of which level of management you are in, the eight practical tactics outlined in this eBook will provide you with concrete steps you can take to motivate and engage your team more effectively.

The Current State of Employee Engagement and Motivation in Companies Around The World

Only 13% of the world's workers are engaged in their jobs. It's a staggeringly small number: think about it, in a room of 100 employees, only 13 are motivated to go above and beyond to do their best in their jobs, and are committed to working hard to reach the company's goals.

Why are 87% of employees not engaged? It boils down to their manager. The state of their relationship with their manager accounts for at least 70% of the variance in employee engagement scores.

"People join organizations – but they leave managers."

A few shocking statistics that show why we need to improve employee engagement:

- 75% of people who willingly leave their jobs don't quit their jobs, they quit their bosses.
- 39% of employees feel underappreciated at work, with 77% reporting that they would work harder if they felt better recognized.
- 89% of employers assume that their employees leave for more money elsewhere, but only 12% of employees actually earn more from their next company.
- 56% of HR managers are worried that their top talent will leave for another job within the year.
- Only 40% of employees are well informed of their company's goals, strategy, and tactics.
- Only 31% thought their senior managers communicated openly and honestly.
- Only 3% thought their managers treated them as key parts of the organization.

More engaged people create better results in the workplace

Researchers have now confirmed the well-established connection between employee engagement and performance outcomes.

Higher motivation and engagement levels mean:

- Better financial performance
- Higher levels of innovation
- Higher customer ratings
- Higher levels of productivity
- Less absenteeism

Given the proven links between employee motivation, engagement and financial outcomes, if an organization increased motivation and the number of engaged employees, they would dramatically improve their balance sheet *and more*.

The Barriers to Growing Employee Engagement

If the benefits of increasing employee engagement are better business results, then why aren't companies doing more to motivate and engage their employees?

Here are 6 common barriers faced by companies and managers:

- **Limited knowledge:** Managers don't know how to increase engagement or where to go to get practical advice and support to improve their team's performance.
- **Defective default assumptions:** Many managers think that people only perform when they are told what to do, or that the only thing that motivates people at work is money.
- **Low interest and understanding:** Some managers have a low level of interest and understanding of engagement because it's seen as being a bit too "HR and fluffy".
- **Unwillingness to empower and trust:** In a strict hierarchical "command and control" culture, managers are not prepared to trust and empower people.
- **No time:** Managers do not take time out of their busy schedules to communicate and understand the key skills and interests of their people.
- **Little external incentive:** The balance sheet and shareholders do not fully value these intangibles.

It's a joint failure of leadership and management that causes poor employee engagement.

Looking at the list above, as a manager...

What do you think are the top 3 barriers that stop you from motivating and engaging your team in a more meaningful way?

Reflect on your company culture as well as your own management style, and identify what's holding you back from achieving higher employee motivation and engagement.

Change Starts From The Top

To change the current state of poor employee engagement, the senior leadership and management of your organization has to be committed to implementing useful strategies that will help raise the levels of motivation and engagement. In this instance, change can only come from the top.

What does engaged senior leadership look like?

- Provide a clear and shared vision for people to align with
- Show visible leadership which demonstrates being in touch
- Be caretakers for creating the right organizational culture
- Behave consistently with organizational values
- Ensure people respect, trust and have confidence in them

Regardless of what senior management is doing, this guide focuses on providing managers like you with the tools and techniques to be better at motivating and engaging your team.

It doesn't matter which level of management you are in! If you manage people, this guide will help you influence the work climate and attitudes within your team.

Your role as a manager

While having the senior leadership in your organization onboard with improving employee engagement is a great win, a manager can still have a significant impact without any major organizational decision-making.

Communication is a key engagement tool. Employees need to feel like their views are sought out and listened to. This is especially true for employees who work the front line and deal with customers, as they often have the best ideas for improvement. They must feel like their opinion counts, and that their ideas will lead to change within the organization.

Ensuring that your employees feel valued and involved creates engagement.

As a manager, you are the one who handles day-to-day interaction with your team, and your leadership can shift your team's attitude and morale in a positive way. It's crucial to demonstrate that you value your employees and want them to be involved in important work issues.

How To Get the Most Out of This eBook

We understand that the concept of employee engagement can be intimidating. Moreover, it's not enough to just know the theory and ideas; more importantly, how can one translate theory into practice?

That's why we structured this eBook in a way that gives you the tools to start growing employee motivation and engagement in small, easy-to-do steps. To guide you on your journey of growing employee motivation and engagement in your workplace, our eight tactics provide practical advice on how to get your team performing at a higher level.

Each motivation and engagement tactic is tied to common concerns voiced by employees. We explain why addressing those concerns are a necessary and important step in creating more engagement in your team. Along with the tactical ideas, we also provide some self-reflection questions to jumpstart the process so that you can start taking action today!

As a manager, we know how valuable your time is – that's why the self-reflection segment is designed to only take 10 - 15 minutes out of your busy schedule.

It's not enough to merely read and understand the ideas presented in this guide – we greatly encourage you to interact with the content in the eBook, and use the information and self-reflection questions as a starting point to make real changes in your workplace.

Remember: effective leadership involves taking action!

Tactic #1: Accelerate daily progress and remove obstacles



Concerns From Employees:

How important is my work?

How can I get things done more efficiently?

One of the greatest motivators at work is the ability to make daily progress on relevant and important work. As a manager, you can help your employees by removing obstacles that hinder their effectiveness, providing resources, and supporting team members to accelerate their progress.

To do this, begin with an assessment of the current workflow. For example, you can take a look at current business processes, implemented procedures, software and hardware used, reporting requirements, and information flow. The aim is to establish if the current situation is ideal.

In most organizations, things are done because they have always been done in a certain way. Be critical, think outside of the box; look and investigate if you can improve things.

Get your team involved by soliciting their feedback. As they are the ones who are deeply involved in the day-to-day work, they will have a clearer idea of the obstacles to their efficiency and effectiveness. Getting them involved in this process also gives them a higher stake in the company's processes and results.

Start Now!

1. *After reviewing your current workflows and processes, what obstacles have you/your team identified?*
2. *What are the top three things that your employees should spend less time on?*
3. *What are the top three changes you can implement to improve performance?*

Tactic #2: Set clear expectations



Concerns From Employees:

What is expected of me?

Setting realistic performance expectations has the greatest impact on employee engagement. When employees know the benchmark that they are aiming for, it drives the entire team forward more effectively. Every person knows their role and how they play a part in helping the organization achieve its goals.

As a manager, how can you set clear expectations on employee performance? One effective method is to have goal-setting discussions and coaching meetings with each individual, and the team as a whole.

Aside from setting goals and getting everyone aligned in the same direction, it is also key to set out performance metrics and timelines. Make sure that progress is reported on a regular basis so everyone knows where they are, and what else is required to reach both individual and team goals.

Start Now!

1. *Evaluate the current performance expectations in place for your team. Ask yourself if the following are clear:*
 - *Are the goals relevant to the business?*
 - *Is the purpose behind the goals clear and is it stimulating?*
 - *Are there too few or too many goals?*
 - *Are your team goals coordinated/aligned with overall organizational goals?*
 - *Are the goals results-based and measurable (SMART)?*
2. *How can you clarify performance expectations so that you can get the best from your team?*
3. *How can you make sure that progress is being reported on the key metrics on a regular basis? How often is progress reported? Which key metrics are most important?*

Tactic #3: Connect the dots to the big picture



Concerns From Employees:

What does my organization stand for?

How do I fit in?

By explaining the connection between employees' individual jobs and the organization, you can greatly increase employee satisfaction.

To connect your employees' work to the organization, have ongoing conversations with your team throughout the year. Share the wider goals of the organization and the department with each team member, and identify the ways in which each person's role is a part of the larger picture.

It's important for employees to know how their work creates value and how it relates to the organization's success. When employees know what the organization stands for and why the things they do are important, they are more motivated to provide quality work.

Start Now!

1. *When was the last time you communicated the company's mission, vision and goals to your team? Take the time to communicate and remind employees of the following during your conversations and meetings:*
 - Who We Are
The organization's goals and strategy, how the organization operates, and what senior leadership aims to achieve.
 - Why We Exist
The organization's mission and vision, and why the organization's strategy and goals matter.
 - How You Help Us Succeed
How the employee's role helps achieve organizational goals

2. *How does your team actually fit in the big picture? What is the value your team offers to the bigger whole?*
3. *How much attention do you give to relating your team's contribution to the company's work? Find more opportunities to tie back your team's work to the overall goals of the company.*

Tactic #4: Be a coach and help develop your employees' skills



Concerns From Employees:

How can I become better at my job and have more influence?

Most employees want to make a difference and to have a voice, a “say” in how the work is done.

As a manager, your role is not just to manage their performance; you're also a coach who helps to bring out the best in your team while developing their skills. Most managers ignore this aspect of their relationship with their team.

There are simple frameworks for structuring coaching conversations. You can help your employees to establish a goal, examine the current reality, explore options, and decide what they will do.

Dr. Joseph Weintraub, Organizational Psychologist, defines coaching as “an ongoing dialogue with the goal of increasing learning and improving one’s ability to perform effectively now and in the future”. This approach uses open-ended questioning combined with listening to lead employees to think about situations differently, and to be open to new ways of acting, all with the intent of bring out their best.

An effective way to do this on a structural basis is to set up a one-on-one coaching program.

A program like this significantly improves performance on both

- a. Subjective factors: e.g. morale, trust, and engagement
- b. Objective factors: e.g. productivity and goal accomplishment

5 key principles of one-to-one coaching meetings:

- Maintain or enhance self-esteem
- Listen and respond with empathy
- Ask for help and encourage involvement
- Share thoughts, feeling and rationale
- Provide support without removing responsibility

Start Now!

1. *Reflect on your management style with your team. What have you done so far to coach your employees one-on-one?*
2. *How can you incorporate more coaching techniques into your interactions and relationships with your team members?*
3. *Explore the possibility of running a structured coaching program in your organization.*

Tactic #5: Give feedback, and reward & recognize good performance



Concerns From Employees:

How well am I doing at work?

I sometimes feel as if nobody sees the things I'm doing.

For an employee, there is no worse feeling than thinking that you are just another small cog in the wheel. This can happen in all types of organizations, but is most likely to occur in large organizations where someone can easily feel as though they don't matter.

How can you, as a manager, combat this feeling in your team? You have to give them feedback, as well as reward and recognition for work well done. This highlights that you are taking notice of their contributions, and that *their work does matter*.

There are many opportunities to provide feedback to your direct reports. While your organization may have instituted formal channels for feedback, reward and recognition, you should also take advantage of informal instances to do so. For example, acknowledge when an employee does something well, and give them sincere, specific, personal positive feedback.

Positive feedback, given in the right way, can motivate employees, sometimes as much as cash bonuses.

5 tips on how to effectively give feedback and recognize your employee's good work:

1. Express your gratitude, praise or thank people immediately.
2. Describe what the employee did right – be specific!
3. Describe how their action helped you, the team, or the organization.
4. Explain how you feel about what they did well. Pause for a moment of silence to let them "feel" how good you feel.
5. Encourage them to do more of the same.

Start Now!

1. *On a scale of 1 – 10, how would you rate the morale of your team?*
2. *When was the last time you gave positive feedback to a team member?*
3. *Think back to the previous week or month. Did someone perform their job well? Who can you recognize or reward for a job well done?*

Tactic #6: Provide on-the-job opportunities for your employees to develop themselves



Concerns From Employees:

I want to develop myself, but don't know how!

Companies that show commitment to helping their employees grow and advance their career are a cut above the rest. You can do this by helping employees create development plans that are achievable and help build their skills for future positions. Achievable plans are focused on on-the-job development activities.

Here are six different types of on-the-job opportunities you can discuss in development conversations:

1. **Give (more) access to expertise:** Shadowing a coworker or working with a recognized expert in the company.
2. **Enrich their job:** Increasing the amount of responsibilities. For example, let them fill in for a manager temporarily.
3. **Increase working pressure:** Letting them work in a situation with rapidly changing circumstances or giving them a crisis to handle at work.
4. **Deal with difficult relationships:** Working with people with contradictory and competing views, working with people from other business units, functions, or locations.
5. **Mentoring:** Letting them mentor and teach how to do a part of their jobs, or letting them mentor new employees in the company.
6. **Increase decision-making responsibility:** Increasing their decision making responsibility, letting them make decisions with potential risk or make a decision outside their area of expertise.

Start Now!

1. *How often do you have development conversations with your employees?*
2. *How can you provide more development opportunities for your team in the next 3 months?*
3. *Who are you going to help in their development?*

Tactic #7: Be open to innovative ideas



Concerns From Employees:

I wish I could talk to my manager about the ideas I have.

Employees feel like they have the most impact when you nurture a work environment that supports innovation and openness to new ideas. In such a work environment, new ideas are not only suggested, but the best ones are actively managed and implemented.

In order for employees to suggest valuable and feasible ideas, share your understanding of business challenges and allow them to brainstorm ideas.

Encourage them to follow this **4-Step Innovation Outline** to solve business challenges more effectively:

- 1. Clearly define the problem*
- 2. Identify the root causes of the problem*
- 3. What is the expected outcome of the idea or innovation?*
- 4. What are the 3 best solutions, including their pros and cons?*

This framework provides employees with a tool to think through and structure their ideas and suggestions, and helps to facilitate the discussion when they bring the idea to you. It's an easy format that provides a structure so that you and your employee can have a more productive discussion when it comes to new ideas to improve the workplace.

A typical Innovation Outline may be one or two pages, and should have sufficient information to be a starting point for the discussion between you and your employee.

Start Now!

1. *How would you describe the current work environment in your office? Does it support innovation and openness?*
2. *How often does your team suggest ideas? What can you do to encourage more brainstorming and creativity?*
3. *At your next brainstorming meeting, introduce the Innovation Outline to help your team come up with new ideas for problems in the workplace.*

Tactic #8: Successful change management involves employees



Concerns From Employees:

I don't really understand why I suddenly have to do things differently!

It is much easier to manage change and keep people moving through transition if leaders can clearly describe the journey people are on.

The 3 'E's of Change Management: Engagement, Explanation, and Expectation

Engagement

Employees want to be engaged with change; they want to be part of the process and have an explanation and understanding what is happening and why. As a manager, ensure that you involve your team in the decisions or the effects of change by asking for their input. Engaging them communicates the management's respect for individuals and their ideas.

Explanation

Explanation of the decision or change means all involved and affected employees should understand why the decisions or changes are made. An explanation allows employees to trust managers' intentions, even if their own ideas have been rejected.

Expectation

Clarity of expectation means that as the manager, you should provide clear guidelines so that everyone knows what to do in this new situation. Although the new expectations may be demanding, employees should know upfront what standards they will be measured by.

Remember: people support what they help to create.

Start Now!

1. *How are you going to involve your employees in your current or next decision/change?*
2. *Evaluate if you have satisfied the 3 'E's of change management, and how you can improve each 'E' next time.*
3. *What are the new specific expectations that you have for each team member? Have you clearly articulated them? Will they/their work be evaluated in a different way?*

What's Your Next Step?

If you want to create positive change in the workplace, as a manager, you must take the first step in showing the way. You have to manage and lead your team into the change, and we hope the eight practical tactics we've shared have inspired you to take action today.

The key to creating a peak performance organization is to become a leading manager who creates a positive, engaging, communicative, purposeful, and development-focused workplace.

This type of manager is what we call a **Master Manager**, and *Lead To Succeed* can help you become one.

In order to become a Master Manager, you should build on the following three layers of interaction and development:

- 1) *Personal Management*: Mindset, productivity, performance, presence, energy, purpose
- 2) *One-on-One Management*: Engagement, coaching, trust, credibility, motivation
- 3) *Team Leadership*: Collaboration, effectiveness, decision making, strategy

Developing these three layers is the core of your leadership development and will put you on the path to exponential success.

Sounds complicated? Sounds like a lot of work? *You will need dedication and commitment, but we promise that it will be worth it.*

At *Lead To Succeed*, we guide you through this journey of growth by breaking down every layer in easy digestible pieces of information with a practical field-proven method.

Our online management training programs offer you a cost-effective, flexible way to gain knowledge and skills at your own time and pace.

For more information on our online management training programs, visit
<http://www.LeadToSucceedNow.com>

About Ramon Janssen, Founder of Lead To Succeed

Ramon is a business professional by education and passion, and has a proven record of accomplishment building, managing and leading several teams within a very competitive IT market. He holds a Bachelor Degree in Marketing (BA Hons), a Master in Business Administration (MBA) and is a Certified Trainer of The Success Principles™ by Jack Canfield and continues to work with the best and brightest in the success and leadership development field.

He founded *Lead To Succeed* in 2016 to help managers become more successful and effective in their jobs, in ways that benefit both the organization and employees. He is an author, Udemy course instructor, trainer and personal coach for professionals who are looking to further develop their skills.

With over two decades of real-life, in-the-trenches business, management and leadership experience, his view is unlike many management coaches. Ramon shows you the big picture, and guides your development towards success by showing you what to do, how to do it, what to say and how to say it.

Known for his lively and encouraging teaching style and his no-nonsense direct approach, he walks you, step-by-step, through proven real-world strategies.

For access to online management training programs and coaching by Ramon, visit <http://www.LeadToSucceedNow.com>

Appendix: Methodology notes and references

Special thanks to the organizations that provided the research behind the statistics listed in this eBook:

The Incentive Federation

The Incentive Research Foundation

Maritz

World at Work

Towers Perrin reported in 2007

Mike Emmott of the CIPD

Gallup

The IES engagement model

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